The Mountainside

Published By the Coolfont Mountainside Association

Volume 3, Issue No. 5 February 1995

Member Voting Critical to future of CMA

The Special Membership meeting scheduled for March 11 will be important to the future of CMA and to the quality of life on the mountainside. The core of the meeting is in two votes which will be taken during the meeting:

1) CMA acceptance of new lands related to the 1994 agreement with Coolfont Development Corporation. The agreement proposes to add 8 lots and approximately 16 acres of adjoining common land to CMA, deliver $110,000 to CMA for use in improving and upgrading our infrastructure, and settle all outstanding issues related to the 1986 agreement.

2) CMA approval of a new triennial assessment which will raise additional funds needed to accomplish the multiple infrastructure upgrade jobs ahead of us.

All CMA members should have received copies of the agreement, a ballot, and information concerning the issues being decided at the meeting. If you have not received this package, please contact CMA President Arleigh Greenblat (202) 333-7697 or CMA Secretary Jackson Bain (703) 549-9592 immediately.

IMPORTANT!

60% of the membership must be present or vote by proxy or mailed-in ballot on these issues. For each of the issues to pass, two-thirds of those votes must be in approval.

Your vote, however you wish to deliver it, is critical to this issue and our future. Please take the time to come to the meeting, mail in your ballot, or send your proxy to a designated CMA member.

GOING TO THE SPECIAL MEETING?

The Special membership meeting will be held Saturday, March 11, in the cafeteria of Walter Johnson High School, 6400 Rock Spring Drive in Bethesda, Maryland

(see the map on the next page).

The meeting will begin at 10 a.m., following a CMA board meeting at 9:00 a.m.

PRESIDENT'S COLUMN

By Arleigh Greenblat

Please place the upcoming March 11th CMA meeting on your calendar. Be assured that it will not just be another general membership meeting adding one more chapter to the water-sewer system upgrade saga.

I believe the planned gathering will ultimately be viewed as a historic moment in CMA history, turning the tide for our organization and putting in place a solid infrastructure to support our community members: home owners, lot owners, permanent residents and persons who rent their homes to others.

By *turning the tide* I mean we will have placed our past troubles behind us and permanently oriented our volunteer help and financial expenditures to a stable future. That future will find a well-managed Coolfont Mountainside Association, respected by everyone served by us as well as all those who provide services to the association.

Official meetings would be used to constructively build management systems, assuring that our members remain satisfied with their organization's efforts.

(continued next page)

I certainly recommend that our members support the new triennial assessment and approve the very moderate expansion to the community. The Board has received no opposition to the proposals before us. In the recent past, members have had their say on the infrastructure and community expansion, this through town meetings and the ballot box. I believe all will agree that CMA has been democratic in our approach to this issue. Hopefully the membership will approve these new plans.

Assuming they do, March 11th will be a celebration day. We won't be drinking champagne because we'll be in a school building, but we will entertain a toast with coffee cups raised to salute the participation of more than forty leaders. Over three years, these members, in effect, constructed the new master plan. Credit should also be given to all those members who gave up their Saturdays to attend meetings and participate in all the debates. The Ashelmans (including Randall) should also get credit, because as we all know, it takes two to tango.

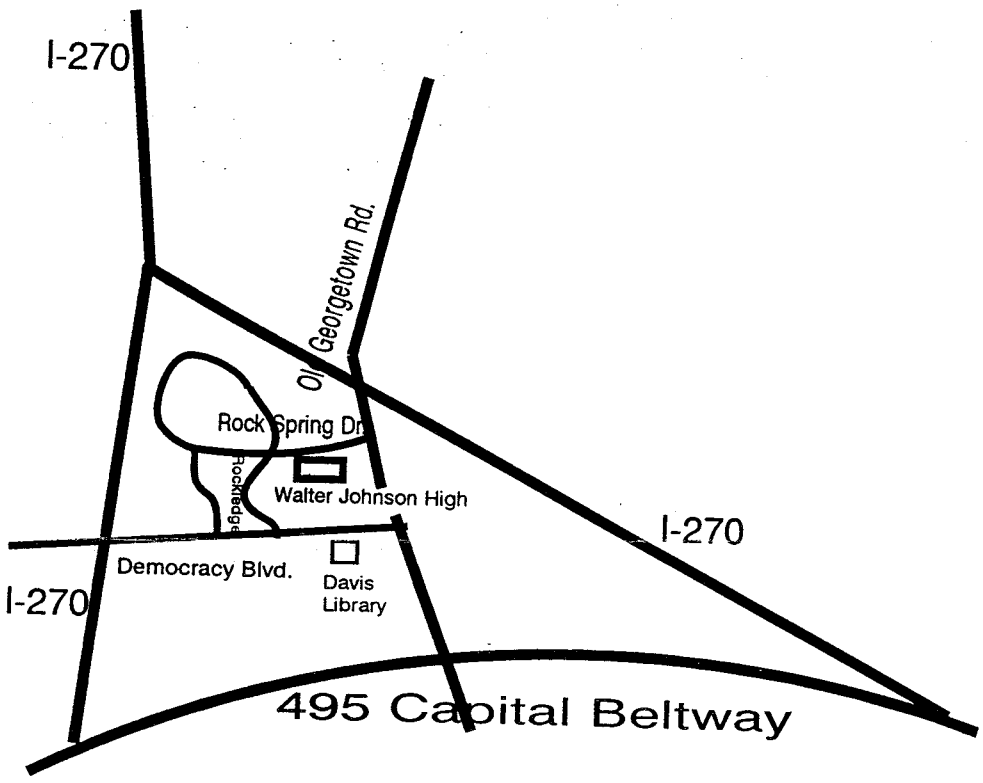
On behalf of the entire leadership, we wish to thank all of you, once again, for your contributions and continuing support. We hope to see you on the 11th!

Arleigh

Directions to Walter Johnson High School:

Walter Johnson High School is at 6400 Rock Spring Drive, which runs off Old Georgetown Road in Bethesda. From Virginia, take the beltway to I-270 North (toward Rockville). Take first exit on Democracy Blvd EAST. Turn left on Rockledge Dr., follow to Rock Spring, turn right. W.J. High School will be on the right. From I-495 (Maryland) , take I-270 North take Old Georgetown Road exit (South toward Bethesda). Turn right on Rock Spring Road, follow to High School on the left.

REMEMBER: The CMA Special Member Meeting is in the School Cafeteria! Board Meeting at 9:00 a.m. (all are welcome to attend) , and the Special Member Meeting starts at 10:00 a.m.

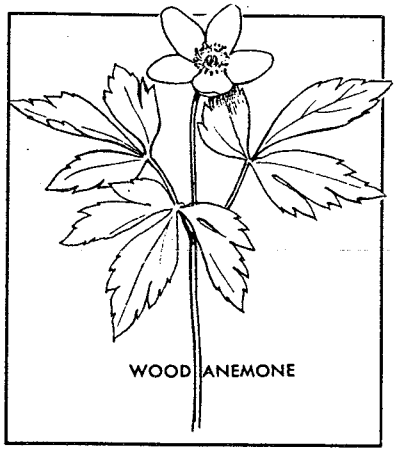


A Little Spring Music, Please.... *In place of our usual "Mountainside Secrets" Guest Column featuring restaurant reviews,, we thought that despite a relatively mild winter, some of you CMA folks might be yearning for a little Spring. Well, Pat Waters has come to the rescue - please enjoy her tour of things to come (soon, we hope!) on our mountainside.*

Spring Wild Flowers

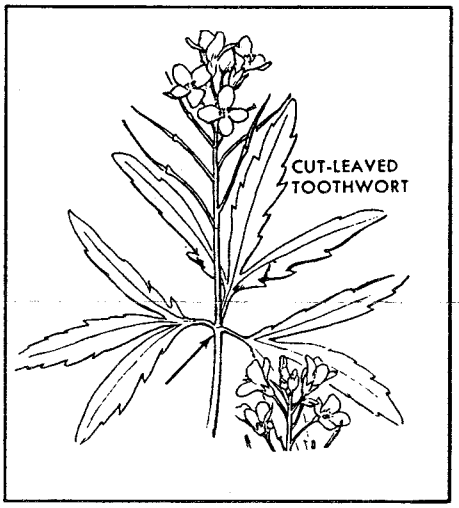
by Patricia Waters

They are all around us, in our woods, fields and on the banks of our streams. Their delicate beauty is there for your enjoyment and they should not be picked.

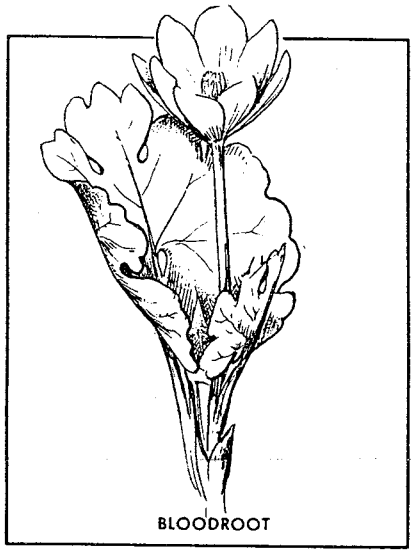


All over our property at K-11 "Folly" we are greeted in early spring by the Wood Anemone (Quinqua Folia). It is a low - delicate plant, thrusting up from the cover of fallen leaves. It usually has five petal-like sepals with whorls of three stalked deeply cut leaves, a solitary white flower, often pink on the reverse side.

Also on our property in early spring is Ragged Toothwort (Dentaria laciniata). It has a terminal cluster of white or pink flowers on an erect stem with deeply cut leaves. Last year it was in bloom on April 17th.

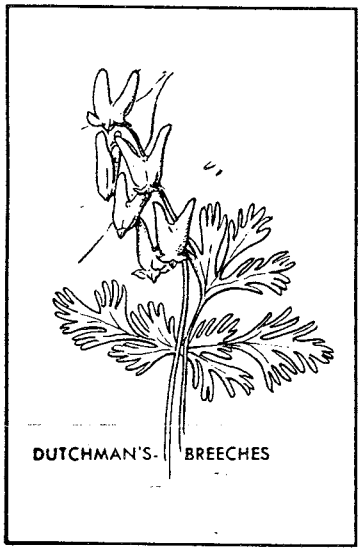


After leaving Coolfont, on the right side of Cold Run Valley Road, (and after passing the Bed and Breakfast "Redbud") you will find bloodroot (Sanguinaria canadensis). It has a smooth stalk with a solitary white flower with a golden orange center. The lobal basel leaf often curls around the stalk.



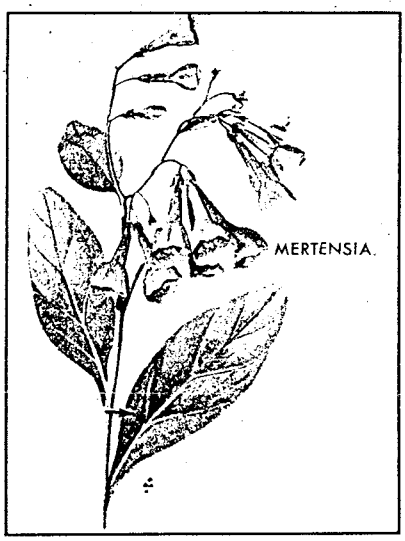
The roots and stems have an acrid red-orange juice. The red juice was used by the Indians as a dye for clothing, war paint, and baskets. You will find it in April and May in many nearby locations.

Another Spring blossom is Dutchman's Breeches (Dicentea cucullaria). Take Route 9W toward Great Cacapon for exactly 4.2 miles past the Panorama Steak House and over the bridge into Great Cacapon. At the end of the bridge immediately turn left. The Breeches are on the bank on the right. It has a delicate spray of waxy yellow tipped blossoms drooping in a ray from an arched stem. The flowers resemble pantaloons. Last year it was in full bloom on April 15th.



A beautiful spring sight for tired winter eyes can be found on the banks of the Cacapon River. It is called Virginia Bluebell or Cowslip (Mertensia virginica).

The nodding trumpet like flowers are pink when in bud and open to a delicate blue. It blooms in April to May and it is a gorgeous sight along the riverbank. To find the Blue Bells, take Route 9W to the junction with Route 29, a total of 20.5 miles. You will have crossed the Cacapon River twice. Turn left on Route 29. Go eight miles to the Forks of the Cacapon. Turn left onto Route 127. Go for one mile and make a sharp left turn over the old bridge. Along the riverbank is a host of Virginia Bluebells. Follow that unmarked road for 6/10 miles bank to Route 29, past a lovely farmhouse on the right. This is a longish trip to see some wildflowers, but they are really worth it. Last year they were in full bloom on April 23.



Of course, apple blossom time is May. Take Route 144W out of Hancock for 1.5 miles, going under the bridge in Hancock and passing Old Mr. Flint's House on the right. Turn left on Roundtop Road. There is a beautiful red brick house on the right. Wander on the backroads and you will see thousands of apple trees in bloom.

These are just a few of the spring wildflowers. Enjoy nature's springtime gift to us.

IN MEMORIAM

Margeret Axtell, a long-time CMA homeowner, died Thursday, February 23. Memorial services were held at St, Marks Episcopal Church in Berkeley Springs on Monday, February 27. Margaret was the owner of the home at A-4. She is survived by her three daughters and two brothers. In lieu of flowers, memorial contributions may be made to the Hospice of Frederick County, 1730 N. Market St., Frederick Maryland 21701, or to St. Mark's Episcopal Church, Berkeley Springs 25411.

SPRING CHANGES TO YOUR HOUSE? CALL DACC FIRST!

by Linda Clark, DACC Chair

Since Spring is here (almost), many homeowners are thinking of sprucing up their properties. A few reminders of items that are required to be approved by the DACC ***prior*** *to getting the work started:*

1. Painting and Staining - Any exterior painting or staining requires advance approval. This applies to painting/staining in the existing color or a proposed change for the siding, doors, or trim. The paint /stain manufacturer, number, and a swatch must be submitted. In order to expedite the approval, a swatch of the existing wood or a photograph would be helpful. Natural colors are acceptable.

2. Major landscaping - This is defined as 10 trees or $1,000 worth of landscaping.

3. Signs - Signs must be approved prior to installation. They must be the same font, color and size as CMA signs.

If you have any questions at all, please call Linda Clark (preferably during the day) at (301) 585-5998.

Thanks,

Linda

DO YOU HAVE IDEAS OR COLUMN SUBMISSIONS FOR THE MOUNTAINSIDE?

FAX OR MAIL JACKSON BAIN:

FAX - (703) 549-9601
ADDRESS - 609 Oakley Place
Alexandria, VA 22302